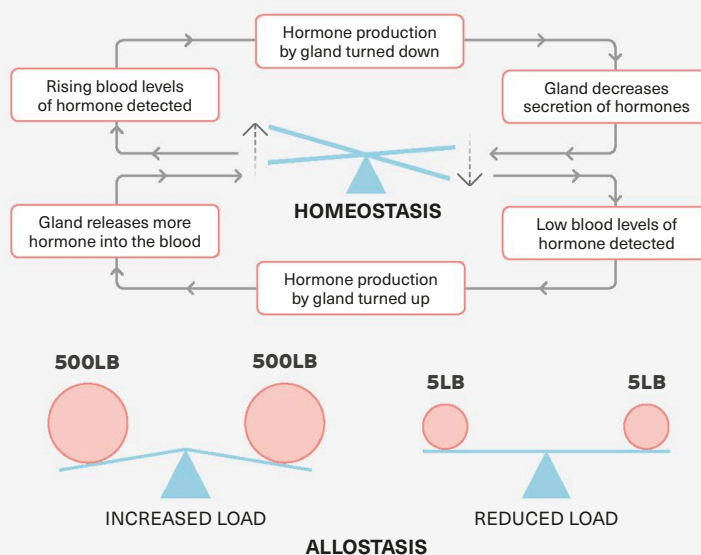




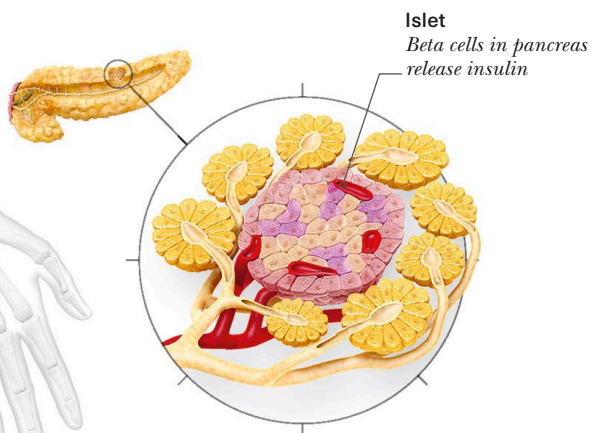
Homeostasis and allostasis

Homeostasis is your body's state of dynamic equilibrium. Most processes—like the control of hormone release, blood calcium and blood sugar levels, and temperature—are tightly regulated through negative feedback, which works in a similar way to a thermostat. Nature wants you to be in balance. Yogis referred to this as *samatra*, which can be translated as equilibrium or equanimity. Allostasis is a process of maintaining homeostasis amid stressors. The more intense the stress, the heavier the “allostatic load” and the more your cells have to work to maintain equilibrium. This increases the likelihood of chronic diseases. Researchers believe that yoga can reduce allostatic load.



PANCREAS

Your pancreas releases insulin to help sugar get into your body cells. However, cells can become insulin-resistant, which can cause disease. A review found that yoga can improve glycemic control, lipid levels, and body composition of fat in those with metabolic syndrome and type 2 diabetes. A doctor-approved reduction in medications was also found.



Pancreatic islets

Inside your pancreas, islets contain different types of cells. Beta cells release insulin, which allows your body cells to use glucose.



Metabolism

Most yoga practices tend to slow your metabolism, which helps your body to be more efficient with less. Although your metabolism may slightly lower from relaxation-based practices, this doesn't mean you will gain weight. A reduction in stress hormones like cortisol also prevents your body from holding onto fat.

